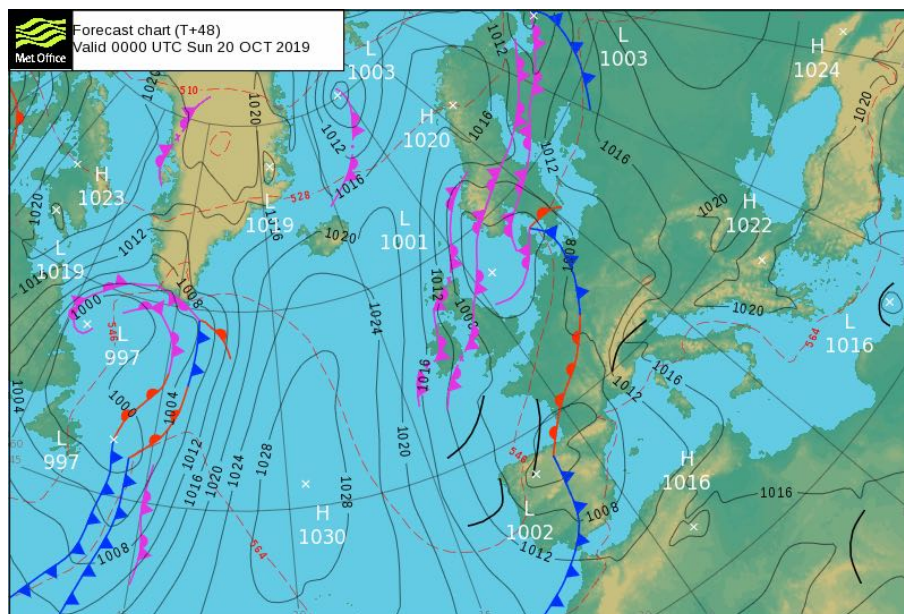
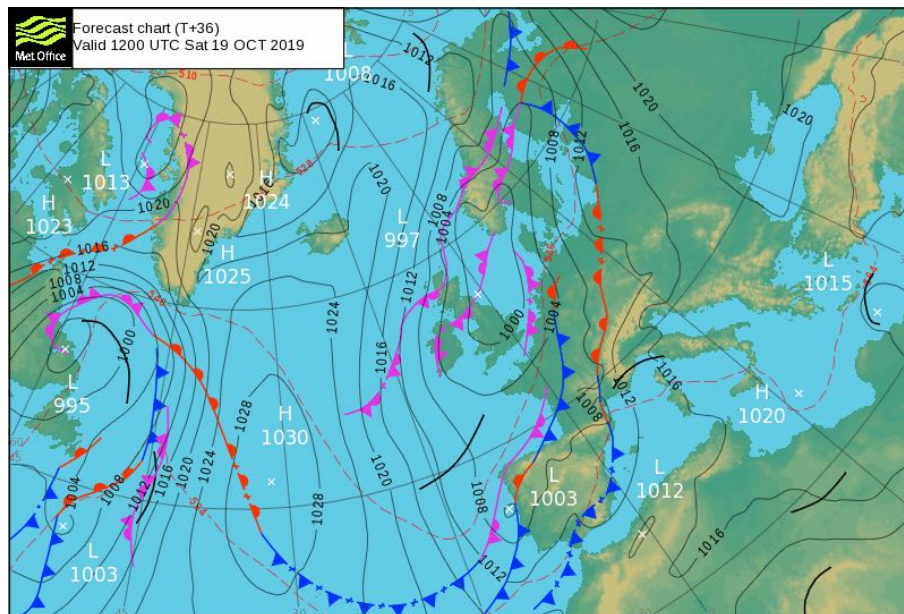


General Situation -

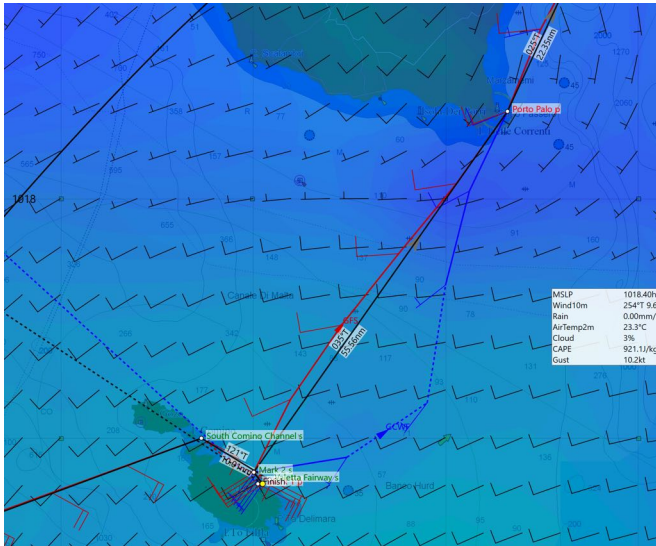
Pretty complicated situation with high pressure dominating the Med and Eastern Europe. Low developing over North East Spain in the coming days.



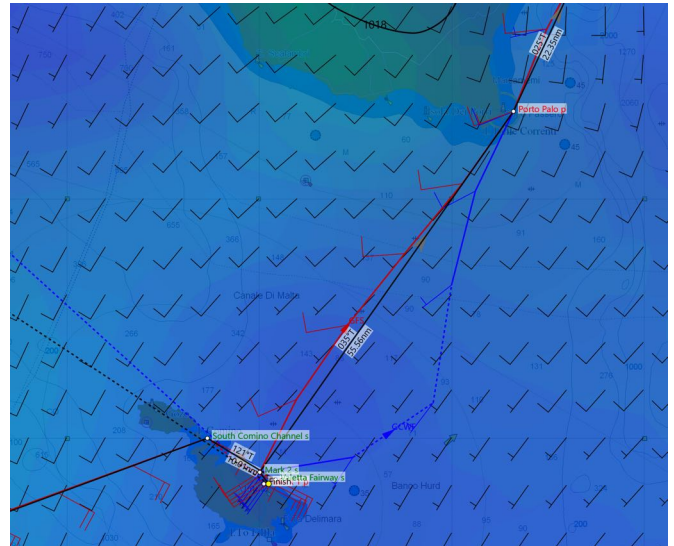
- S-SE flow in general, going left round the Western end of Sicily, and right round Cabo Passero.
- Light winds, with enhancing local effects for the first half of the race.
- Low forming N Africa early Mon developing in the Med, giving a squeeze to the gradient and stronger ESE winds, potentially 30 knots for a time, after rounding Favignana.

Start to Passero -

- Light start 4-8 knots from 220-240, going right as you head towards Sicily. Lighter on the coast at Passero, but with some acceleration on the corner.
- Slight build as you approach Capo Passero between 1800 and 2000, continuing to go right but then drop as you head north along the Sicilian coast.



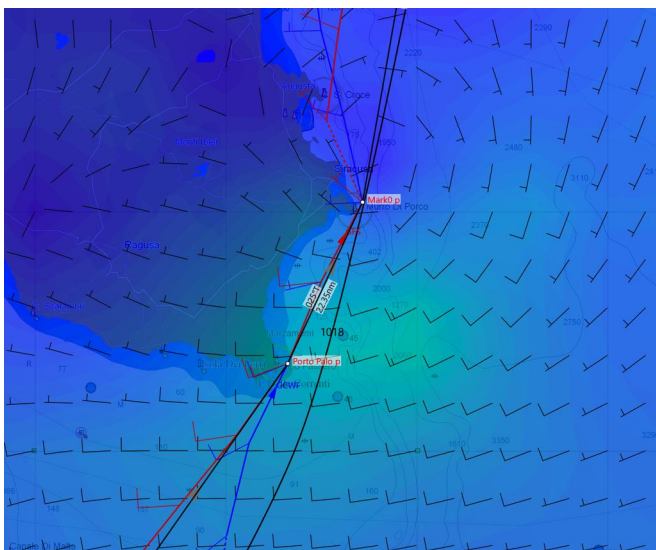
1400 hours GFS



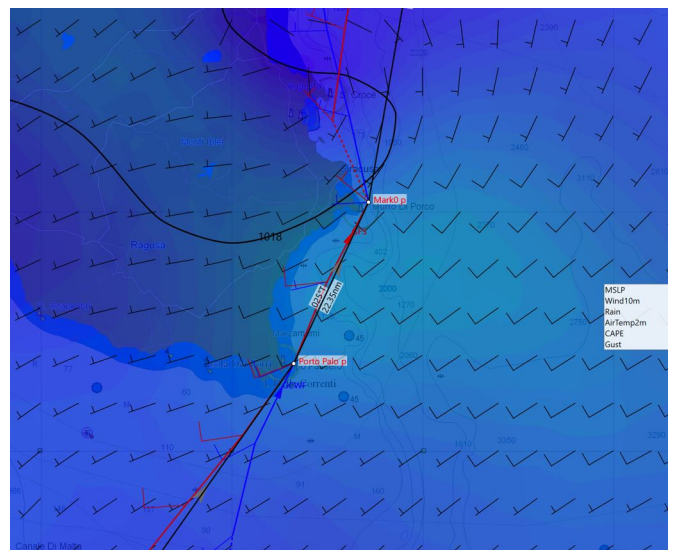
1400 hours GCWF

Passero to Siracusa -

- Approaching Siracusa 0000-0300 Sun in light breeze 5 knots from 275-295. Then playing the local land breeze through the night in very light conditions.
- Looking for puffs from the land.
- Slightly more pressure offshore but hard to get to it and potentially costly if stuck in transition.
- I think that playing the fleet is more important here, as the leg from Siracusa to the Straits will be tricky to predict.



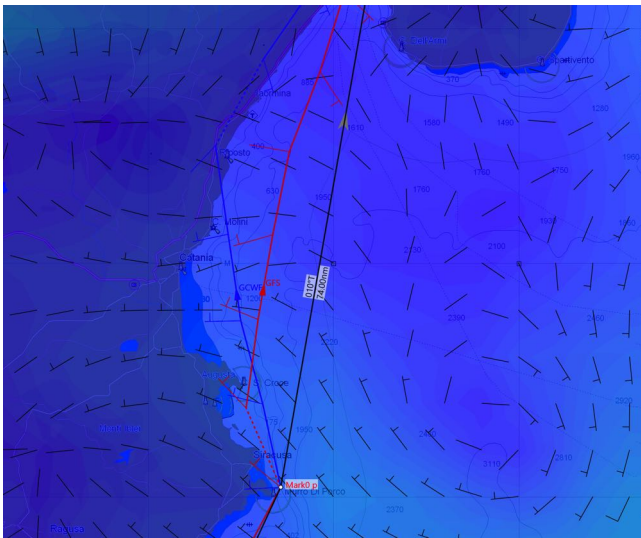
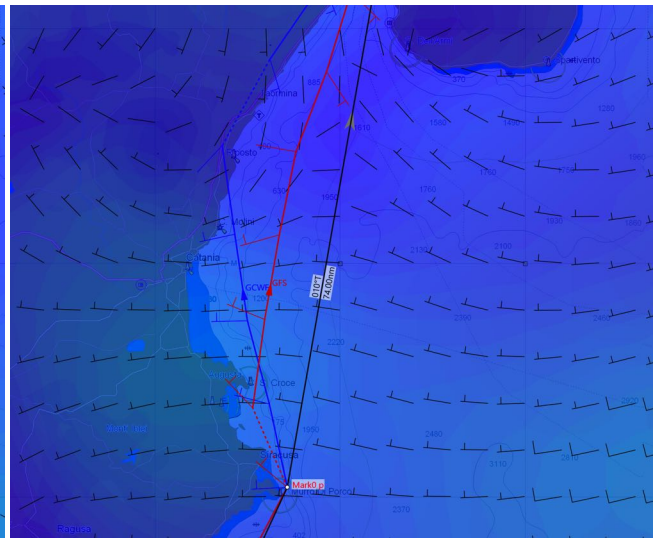
2000 hours GFS



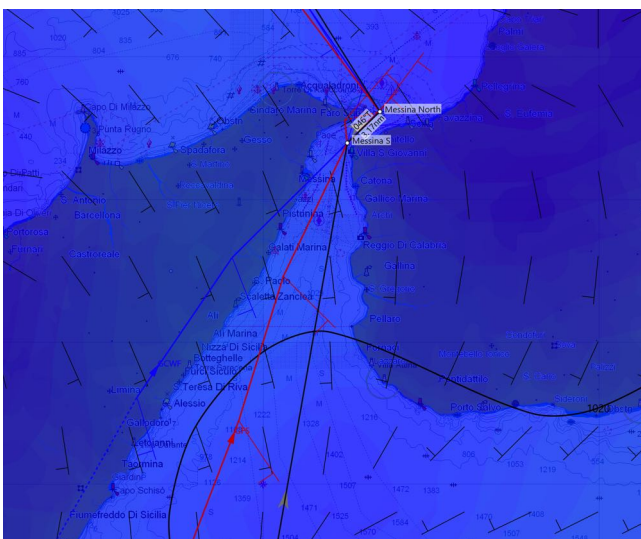
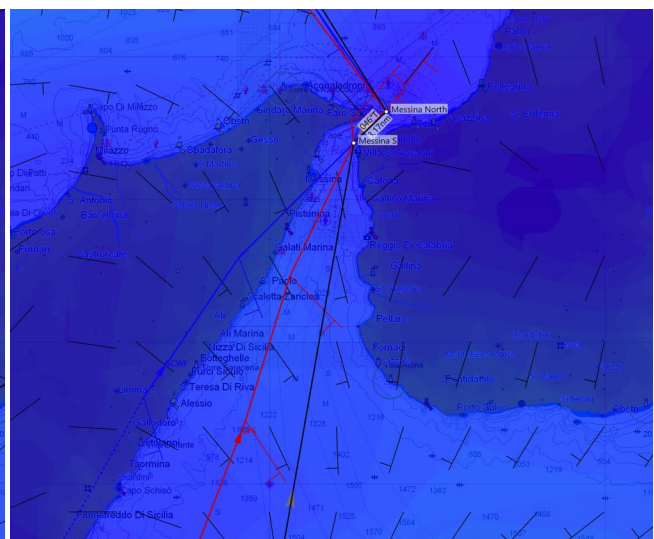
2000 hours GCWF

Siracusa to Straits -

- EC is showing sw, then westerlies building to 9 knots once clear of Siracusa up to Catania where it drops again.

**0300 hours GFS****0300 hours GCWF**

- Big light spot behind Etna and then a transition into light southerly gradient as you approach the Straits.

**1000 hours GFS****1000 hours GCWF**

Straits -**Tidal gate at Messina -**

- You need to be trying to head through Messina on the north going flow between 0635 and 1326, or between the 2 periods of slack water, if at all possible.
- The routing, GFS and GCWF has you there a little after that, so it will be best to get out of the current until you hit slack water again at about 2030.
- The north of the channel, Sicily side, looks like it has less current, but it may not be feasible to get there.
- If you are slower than the gibs/routing you will have to fight the south going current until it changes - this will probably give you the whole of the next tide to get washed through to the north.

Tabella correnti
ottobre 2019

Leggenda: **STANCA** Montante **Scendente**

Punto di calcolo: Centro Ganzirri / Punta Pezzo Cambia

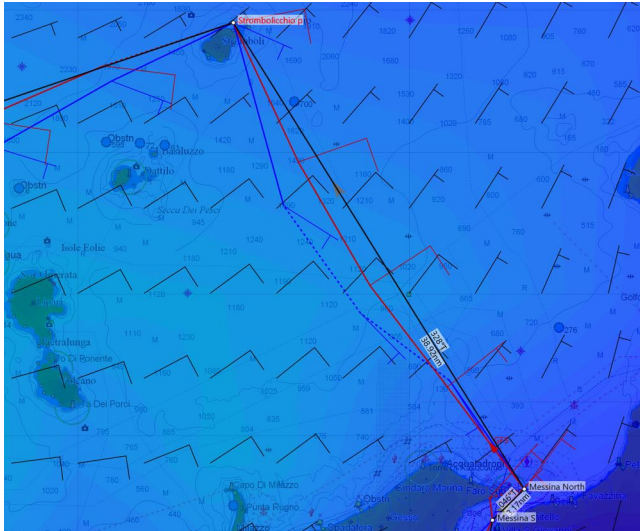
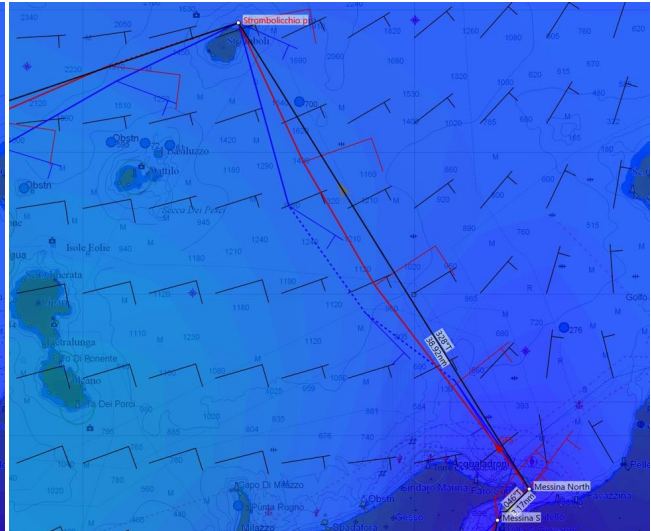
N.B. per alcuni punti con corrente trascurabile, i risultati potrebbero essere non significativi.

GG	STANCA	PICCO	STANCA	PICCO	STANCA	PICCO	STANCA	PICCO
	Slack	North flowing	Slack	South flowing	Slack	North flowing	Slack	South flowing
19	05:37	08:39 3.1 NODI	12:25	15:45 3.5 NODI	19:16	21:05 0.9 NODI	23:19	03:38 3.4 NODI
20	06:35	09:43 3.1 NODI	13:26	16:45 3.7 NODI	20:23	22:23 1.0 NODI	---	---

- Use this website <http://correntidellostretto.it/>. and adjust the date/time for your approach.

Straits to Stromboli -

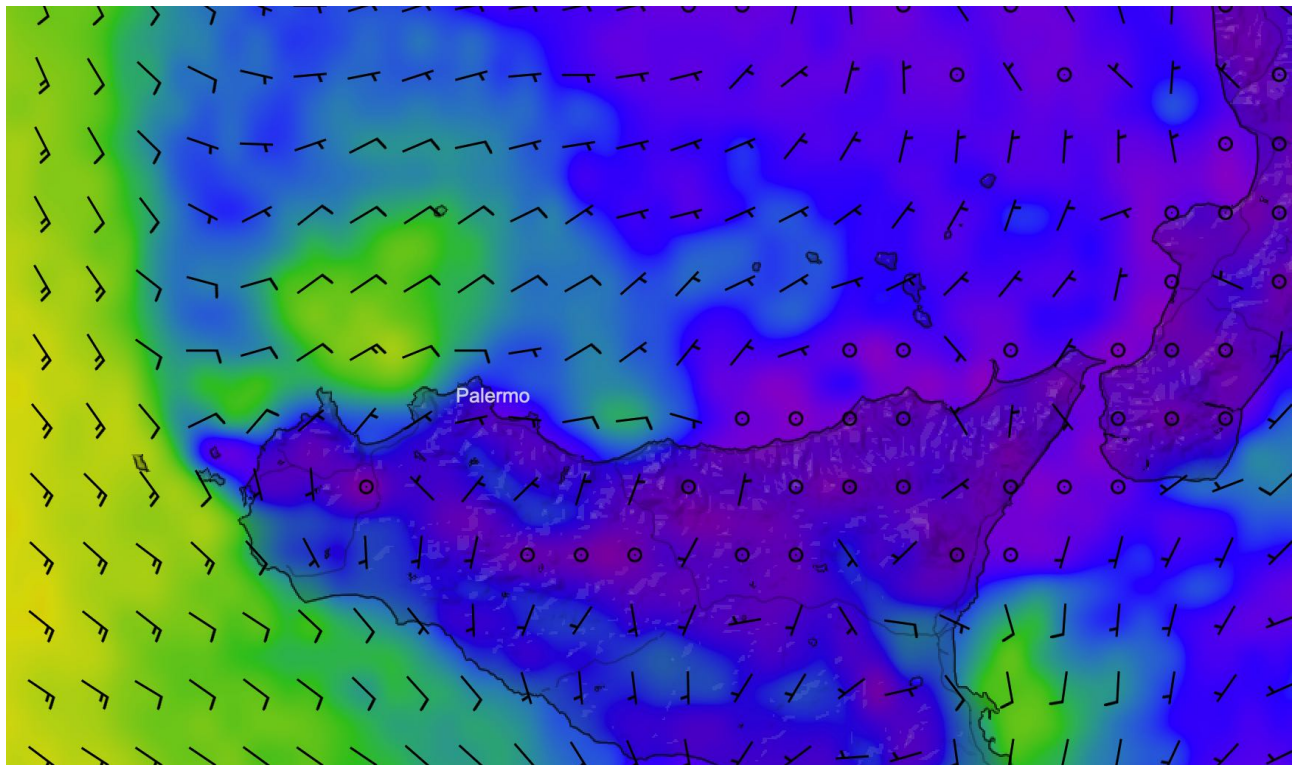
- Tough transition into the gradient north of the Straits.
- Looking for NNE breeze 3-6 knots that will veer and build a little as you head NNW. Potentially 4-7 knots from 110-120 as you get to Stromboli early morning on the 21st.
- EC forecasting a little more, maybe 10 knots and a little more right.

**1700 hours GFS****1700 hours GCWF****Stromboli - sometime between 2200 and 0400**

- Playing the fleet game again, and using the tracker as a benchmark for how close you go. Light downwind as you try and get round the island.

Stromboli to Favignana -

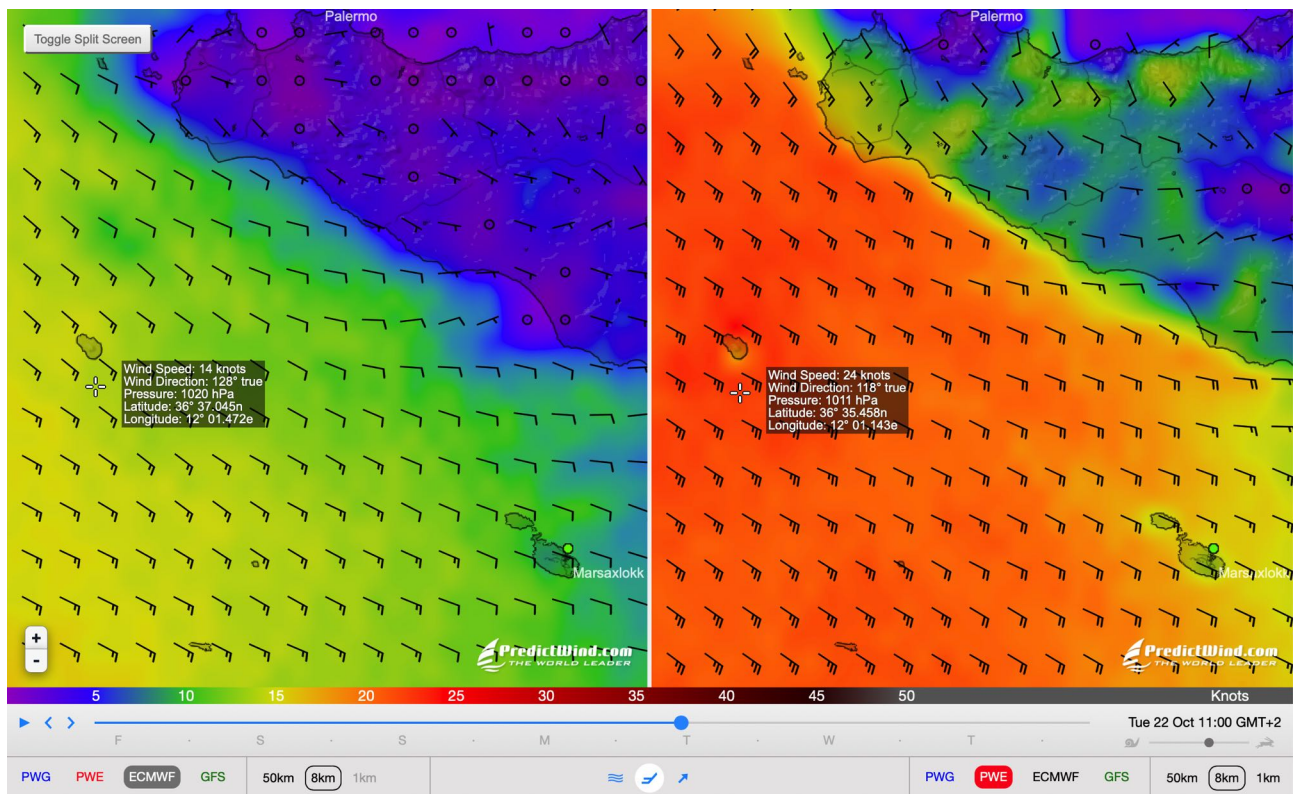
- Looking pretty fickle here, routing suggesting a rhumb line course.
- Inshore, left of rhumb could be dangerous as there will be a transition zone stretching all the way to the islands caused by the effect of Etna and the mountains.
- Breeze will again veer to the SE and continue to build as you approach Lenvanzo and Favignana.
- Models are starting to differ here. GFS arriving at the western end of Sicily at 1700, GCWF some 6 hours later



1700 hours 21/10 EC

Favignana to Comino -

- Steadily building gradient from the SE for the whole of this leg.
- All on port to Lampedusa, then Stb to Camino.
- Could see as much as 30, more in any squalls, good news is there is not much Cape activity until the 24th and you should be home by then!!
- EC is showing a lot less than the other models, so will be worth monitoring.
- You will carry the pressure to the Camino channel.
- Sea state doesn't look too bad 1m, with a 4 sec period dropping a little as you approach Malta.

**Camino to Finish -**

- Long way off, but doesn't look to funky - 16-20 VMG upwind.

Summary -

1. Start to Passero - Light start, building a little and going right as you approach Sicily.
2. Passero North - Tricky leg overnight from Passero, past Siracusa towards the Straits. Playing the land breezes and the fleet.
3. Transition to contend with as you clear the lack of land breeze behind Etna.
4. Straits - Careful timing of the arrival into the Straits - may not be possible to time as very light southerly.
5. Straits to Stromboli - Once clear of the straits, it looks like point and shoot for Stromboli.
6. Light wind rounding of Stromboli, playing the fleet and watching the trackers for park ups.
7. Stromboli to Favignana - Difficult leg to Favignana - south of rhumb line looks dangerous. Might kick to NE before filling in properly from SE as you get to Favignana.
8. Favignana to Comino - Upwind in building breeze. GFS and PWE forecasting up to 30, EC 15-20.
9. Comino to finish - VMG upwind.